

Your first LinkedIn post. What to say and how to say it.

For professionals who have never posted on LinkedIn professionally — how to start without feeling performative, what actually gets attention, and what a sustainable 4-week cadence looks like.

IF YOU TAKE NOTHING ELSE AWAY

Five things that matter most

- One post that shows genuine insight about your industry is worth more than ten motivational posts about your job search.
- Recruiters and hiring managers look at LinkedIn content. The candidates who post stay visible between applications.
- You don't need a large following. You need the right people to see it — and that's mostly your existing connections.
- Short posts outperform long ones almost always. 3-5 sentences with a strong first line beats a 500-word essay.
- Write about what you actually know, not what you think you should say. The authentic version always lands better.

The goal of posting on LinkedIn during a search isn't to go viral. It's to stay visible to the people who already know you, and occasionally reach someone new who finds the content genuinely useful.

Most candidates don't post anything during their search. Which means those who do stand out by default.

FIVE POST TYPES THAT WORK

Start here — not with a blank screen

Type 1: A lesson from a career moment

"The most counterintuitive thing I learned building the [function] at [company] was [specific insight]. Most people assume [common belief]. In practice, [what you found instead]." This demonstrates expertise through specificity, not credential-dropping.

Type 2: A pattern you've noticed in your industry

"I've been in [industry] for [X years] and I keep seeing the same thing: [pattern]. The companies that handle it well do [specific thing]. The ones that struggle usually [specific alternative]. Here's why I think that is." Demonstrates market intelligence. Recruiters flag this for hiring managers.

Type 3: A myth debunked

"Everyone in [industry/function] says [common belief]. I don't think that's right anymore. Here's what I've seen work instead." Disagreement is the highest-engagement format on LinkedIn when grounded in real experience.

Type 4: A specific tool or framework you use

"When I take over a [function], the first thing I do is [specific action] because [specific reason]. It saves [time/cost/headcount] because [mechanism]. It took me [X years] to figure this out." Useful, specific, expertise-demonstrating.

Type 5: Your transition (once, done well)

"I've left [company] and I'm looking for my next thing. I spent [X years] doing [what]. The thing I'm most proud of: [one specific accomplishment]. I'm looking for [specific role] in [industry]. If you know someone I should talk to, I'd be grateful." Specific enough to be actionable. Post this once. Don't repeat it.

One post per week is enough

Week 1

Your transition post. Specific, warm, forward-looking. Post on Tuesday or Wednesday morning.

Week 2

A lesson from your career. Something you genuinely learned that others in your field might find useful.

Week 3

A pattern or observation from your industry. Recruiters in your space will see it.

Week 4

A practical framework or tool. Shows depth of expertise without selling anything.

NEXTCAPTER TOOL

The Thought Leadership Studio generates five post ideas from your résumé background and a 4-week content calendar. Unlocks at Tier 3 (200 points) at launchyournextchapter.com